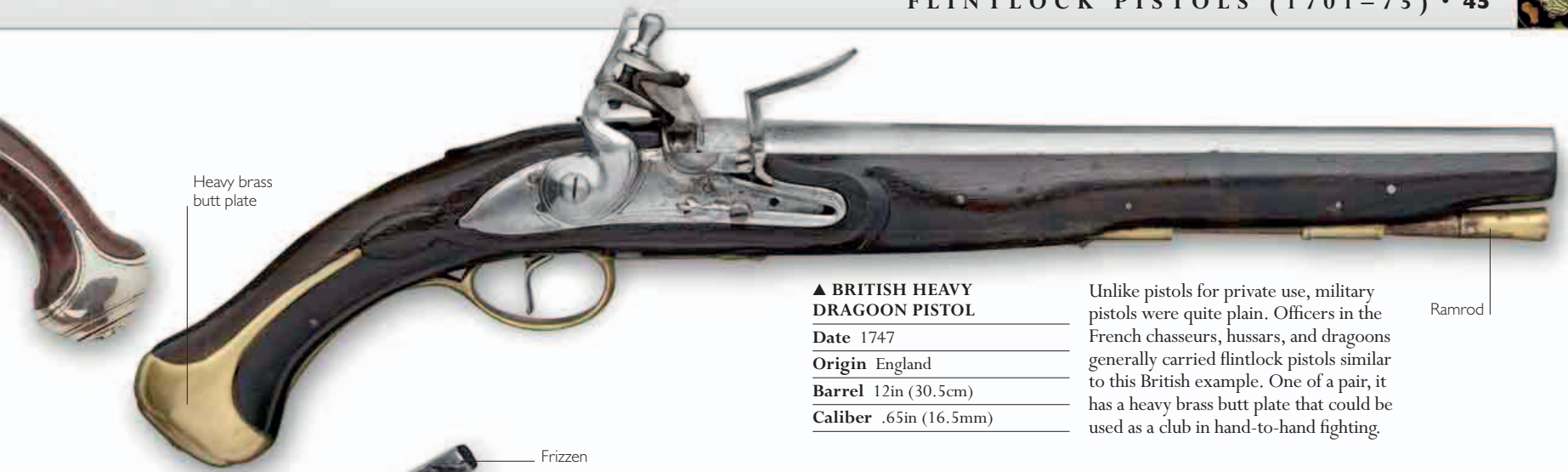




▲ BRITISH HEAVY DRAGOON PISTOL

Date 1747
Origin England
Barrel 12in (30.5cm)
Caliber .65in (16.5mm)

Unlike pistols for private use, military pistols were quite plain. Officers in the French chasseurs, hussars, and dragoons generally carried flintlock pistols similar to this British example. One of a pair, it has a heavy brass butt plate that could be used as a club in hand-to-hand fighting.

Ramrod



FULL VIEW

▼ SCOTTISH PISTOL

Date c.1750
Origin Scotland
Barrel 9in (23cm)
Caliber .57in (14.4mm)

At this time, it was the fashion in Scotland to make pistols entirely of brass or iron, with their surface covered by intricate engraving. Typically, they lacked trigger guards. Most were snaphances; this example is unusual in that it is a flintlock. It was made by Thomas Cadell of Doune, who made some of the best iron pistols.



Barrel is engraved all over



◀ DOUBLE-BARRELED TAP-ACTION PISTOL

Date 1763
Origin UK
Barrel 2in (5.1cm)
Caliber .22in (5.6mm)

In this pistol, a rotating rod—operated by a small “tap” handle on the left side—lies beneath the cock. The pan is formed out of a shallow channel in the rod. A touchhole in the pan connects with the upper barrel. Once this barrel is fired, the tap is turned and another pan appears, whose touchhole is connected to the lower barrel. This enables two shots to be fired in quick succession.



Butt has incised decoration

Cock has lost upper jaw to flint clamp

Tap

Frizzen spring



▲ LIÈGE PISTOL

Date 1765
Origin Belgium
Barrel 9in (23cm)
Caliber .62in (15.7mm)

Made in the city of Liège by M. Delince, this holster pistol appears to have been shortened at the muzzle, and shows signs of heavy use. This example lacks the internal reinforcing bridle, which was standard at the time, to stop the frizzen screw from breaking under the force of the falling cock.

Cock

Frizzen

Langets reinforced wooden stock

Trigger guard

Brass butt plate